

Why some interpretable deviations count as ungrammatical: grammatical-choice profiles and public-update consequences

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Abstract

Why can an intelligible deviation be classified as ungrammatical in one case, but as odd meaning, bad wording, accent, style, or social conduct in another? I propose that such classifications fallibly track the relation that failed in a community's inventory of conventional form–meaning pairings. A grammatical choice isn't merely any conventional system: it recurs at a constructional choice site, relates expression to a language-specific value or function, and is constrained by a community licensing pattern. Strict paradigms are a strong case, but construction-sized and partly lexicalized relations create graded and moving edges. A token can lack a viable analysis, combine incompatible values, leave an obligatory contrast unsupplied, select the wrong paradigm value, or use an unlicensed realization. By contrast, a poor lexical, stylistic, or social choice may preserve the relevant form–meaning pairings and instead mis-select content, persona, situation, or conduct. Production, substitution, omission, semantic, and distributional evidence can place these relations without using the fault labels to be predicted. The primary claim is prospective: stronger independently assigned GRAMMATICAL-CHOICE PROFILES should predict more consistent grammar-directed attribution in held-out cases. Within that architecture, a graded public-update profile identifies one consequential subset. Building on Heltoft and Nørgård-Sørensen, I predict that its strength increases the difference in update-directed repair between wrong-value and value-preserving-realization errors. Abrusán's semantic-repairability account, Boye and Harder's discursive secondary status, processing, schooling, and sanction remain live alternatives. Either projection can fail without turning the other into a definitional success.

Keywords: grammaticality; form–meaning pairing; grammatical choice; operator profile; public update; repair

Version note. An earlier version posted as LingBuzz/009706 proposed a broader coordination account of selective grammaticality. This article replaces its categorical operator-stratum taxonomy with a graded profile over independently identified form–value assembly relations and recasts repair as a downstream test of a broader account of selective grammatical classification.

AI USE. The large language models Claude Opus 4.5 and Claude Fable; a preview model with no disclosed developer or underlying-model identity, accessed through OpenCode Zen in August 2026; ChatGPT 5.2 Pro; and GPT-5.5 served as drafting and editing aids throughout the preparation of this paper. I am responsible for all theoretical claims, arguments, errors, and interpretive choices.

I THE SELECTIVE-CLASSIFICATION PROBLEM

The initiating example looks too small to carry a theory. In ordinary connected Reference French, *hiver* ‘winter’ begins with H MUET, so the singular definite article undergoes obligatory elision: *l’hiver*, not **le hiver* (Boersma, 2007; Simonenko & Carlier, 2020). Yet the deviant form remains readily interpretable. *Le* still expresses masculine singular definiteness; what fails is its conventional morphophonological realization. The deviation is neither a wrong referent nor a wrong definiteness value. Nor is it merely any French-accent difference. The realization relation belongs to the article construction, and that location makes the example a candidate grammatical form error.

This case generated the paper’s question. Why do some interpretable departures count as grammar, while others count as semantic anomaly, poor wording, pronunciation, style, or social conduct? The contrast can’t be reduced to meaninglessness: **le hiver*, **goed*, and many agreement errors are transparent. Nor can it be reduced to expressive substance. Tone, intonation, word order, gesture, and segmental morphology can all realize grammatical contrasts, while segmental differences can also mark accent or style. An asterisk records a classification; it doesn’t yet explain that classification.

Two questions are often run together. SOURCE ATTRIBUTION asks what caused a negative response: grammatical knowledge, processing load, frequency, schooling, social evaluation, or something else. TARGET CLASSIFICATION asks what the respondent treats as having failed: a construction, a grammatical value, its realization, lexical content, style, stance, or the social act. The acceptability literature’s source-ambiguity problem concerns the first question (Hofmeister et al., 2013; Leivada & Westergaard, 2020). This paper asks how the second can be predicted without reading the answer from the response it is meant to explain.

The proposed answer begins from a familiar but insufficient observation: grammar consists centrally of conventional pairings between expression and content or function, at grains ranging from words to abstract constructions (Goldberg, 1995; Sag, 2012). Phonemic contrasts ordinarily keep expressions apart rather than pairing each contrast with a meaning; orthography ordinarily maps graphic forms to linguistic expressions. But the pairing criterion alone can’t separate grammar from the lexicon or from social meaning. A word and an enregistered style also pair form with value.

The decisive question is relational: *which relation does the departure fail?* Selecting an inapposite but otherwise licensed word preserves that word’s form–meaning pairing; a register mismatch can preserve both the proposition and the social value conventionally indexed by the form. Trouble is then directed at chosen content, situational fit, persona, or conduct. A grammatical departure instead compromises the conventional assembly of form–meaning relations: an analysis is unavailable, grammatical instructions conflict, an obligatory contrast is missing, a construction is excluded, a paradigm value is mis-selected, or an intended value receives an unlicensed realization. Lexical and social material can enter grammar when recruited into such a constructional relation; morphology, tone, or word order doesn’t count as grammar merely by virtue of its substance.

This answer would be circular if “grammatical relation” were assigned from the same asterisks and corrections it later explained. I propose a graded GRAMMATICAL-CHOICE PROFILE, assigned from

independent evidence: semiotic and constructional assembly, contrastive choice architecture, and conditioned community licensing. These properties are neither a classical checklist nor a synonym for “system”. They order candidate relations for a prospective claim: higher independently assigned profiles should predict more consistent grammar-directed fault attribution in held-out cases. A stable failure defeats or splits that claim; it can’t be repaired by moving the category edge after the labels are seen.

Strict paradigms in the sense developed by Nørgård-Sørensen and Heltoft occupy one strong region of this profile space. Constructional licensing supplies another, often layered, route. Within either route, a token may fail at the level of coverage, compatibility, saturation, community licensing, value, or realization. This imports the main separations of OVMG without importing its population dynamics: OVMG distinguishes the status of a candidate from the evidence available to a speaker and from the resulting experience or label (Reynolds, 2026a). This paper asks what kind of linguistic target that label purports to identify.

Public-update function then contributes a narrower projection rather than a definition of grammar. A graded PUBLIC-UPDATE PROFILE measures how strongly a paradigm’s values conventionally configure move type, commitment or source, discourse continuity, and response relevance. A wrong switch-reference value can change which participant is carried forward; a malformed realization of the same intended value need not. The OPERATOR-PROFILE HYPOTHESIS predicts that this value–realization difference in update-directed repair grows with a profile assigned before held-out responses are coded. **le hiver* matters precisely because it shows why this operator-specific claim can’t define grammaticality: the definite value survives even though its realization is excluded.

The paper thus proposes three separable projections. The primary one concerns selective fault attribution across grammatical, lexical, phonological, orthographic, stylistic, pragmatic, and social targets. The second concerns variable and moving attribution at intermediate or changing edges. The third concerns the downstream consequences of wrong values within a subset of grammar. Repeated opportunities and competitor strength can explain why a transparent form becomes sharply excluded (Reynolds, 2026a); they don’t by themselves decide which relation failed or where subsequent trouble will be directed.

Section 2 positions that test against the closest partial answers. Sections 3 and 4 develop the choice profile and the operator-specific coordinate. Section 5 develops worked comparisons. The final sections compare rival predictors and state held-out designs in which each projection can fail.

2 PRIOR CONSTRAINTS AND LIVE ALTERNATIVES

Abrusán’s programme is the closest precedent in problem shape. Abrusán (2019, pp. 329–331, 344–348) asks why failed interpretation can produce semantic anomaly, pragmatic infelicity, or ungrammaticality. Abrusán et al. (2021) develop an answer in terms of semantic reparability: local conflicts involving lower-level, context-shiftable types can leave a recoverable predication, whereas conflicts involving constitutive high-level types can be nonlocal and resist meaning-preserving shift. The type architecture and shift predictions are independently motivated, yielding a real explanation of one classification boundary. Its native explanandum is semantic anomaly and the semantically or pragmatically analyzed subset of ungrammaticality. It doesn’t purport to classify article elision, suppletive allomorphy, constructional exclusion, accent, or social sanction.

The source-ambiguity literature supplies a complementary constraint. A low rating doesn’t re-

veal whether grammar, processing, interpretation, or contextualization produced it (Hofmeister et al., 2013); grammaticality and acceptability can dissociate in both directions (Leivada & Westergaard, 2020). In functional terms, grammaticality concerns fit to relatively stable conventional knowledge rather than acceptability in one act of use, but corpus distributions, processing measures, and judgments are all indirect evidence for that knowledge (Poulsen, 2012, pp. 12–20). No single response may be used both to locate a fault and to explain why the fault was located there.

Coseriu provides a deeper historical precedent for differentiated fault domains. His system–norm–speech distinction separates functional possibilities, customary social realization, and individual production, while later presentations distinguish congruence, idiomatic correctness, and situational appropriateness (Coseriu, 1952; Pardo Llibrer, 2021; Soto Vergara, 2022). This paper doesn’t rediscover differentiated evaluation. It asks which independently measurable properties predict a particular allocation in later behaviour.

Construction Grammar supplies the broad semiotic ontology. Words, idioms, partly filled patterns, and abstract constructions are conventional form–meaning pairings rather than outputs of a grammar divided cleanly from a lexicon (Goldberg, 1995; Sag, 2012). That inheritance rules out an easy substance boundary, but it leaves the present question open. A licensed word can be badly chosen without its pairing failing; a construction can be unlicensed even when its content is transparent. The distinction to be explained concerns relations and fault targets inside a structured inventory, not between meaningful words and meaningless syntax.

Heltoft’s work is the closest positive scaffold. His analyses distinguish grammaticality from comprehensibility and treat mood, word order, particles, and other paradigms as resources for illocutionary and interlocutionary organization (Hansen & Heltoft, 2011; Heltoft, 1981, 2005; Jakobsen & Heltoft, 2012). Nørgård-Sørensen and Heltoft (2015) generalize the paradigm architecture: bounded alternatives occupy a recurring domain and contrast within a language-specific semantic frame. Their architecture reaches beyond morphology, and their Danish V2 analysis already joins paradigm structure to assertivity. This paper adopts that scaffold. It doesn’t claim that either paradigms or interactional grammar are new. Their additional marked–unmarked asymmetry anchors the strict paradigmatic core considered below. It neither defines all grammar nor warrants an inference from paradigmhood to categorical judgment. Less bounded, construction-sized, or item-restricted relations can share some of the profile without satisfying the full paradigm definition.

Boye and Harder are the principled alternative, not a minor comparison. They treat closed paradigms and obligatoriness as incidental to grammatical status; conventional ancillarity and discursive secondary status are constitutive, with focusability and addressability as diagnostics (Boye & Harder, 2012). Their account directly competes with the grammatical-choice profile as an account of status. Its diagnostics can also compete with the public-update profile in the narrower repair study. If discursive secondary status predicts held-out fault attribution or subsumes the proposed repair interaction, the corresponding new profile hasn’t earned an additional explanatory role.

Interactional grammar and repair research shows that grammar is a resource for sequential action and supplies coding precedents for downstream trouble and correction (Dingemanse et al., 2014; Fox et al., 1996; Muntigl & Ventola, 2010). Update semantics and clausal-operator accounts supply the dimensions of move, commitment, and response potential used below (Bentley et al., 2023; Farkas & Bruce, 2010; Hengeveld & Mackenzie, 2008; Murray, 2014; Stalnaker, 2002). Neither literature already contains the two frozen comparisons proposed here: from a graded choice profile to fault-

Programme	Native explanandum	Independent predictor	Residual question here
Abrusán and colleagues	semantic anomaly, pragmatic infelicity, and semantically driven ungrammaticality	type level, locality, and meaning shift	form, construction, style, and social-act targets
Coseriu	system, normal realization, speech, and evaluative domains	functional opposition and norm-relative realization	held-out allocation and gradience of token faults
Construction Grammar	learned inventory across lexicon and syntax	conventional form–meaning pairings at multiple grains	why one licensed pairing is badly chosen while another pairing relation fails
Heltoft and Nørgård-Sørensen	language-specific grammatical paradigms and their content	domain, frame, bounded alternatives, obligatory choice, markedness	graded extension beyond strict paradigms and held-out attribution
Boye and Harder	grammatical status and grammaticalization	discursive secondary status	comparison with choice profile and repair locus
Source ambiguity and functional acceptability	causes of ratings and evidence for stable conventional knowledge	triangulated grammar, processing, and context measures	target classification rather than response cause

Table 1: The closest partial answers. The final column states a difference in scope or design, not a defect in the predecessor.

domain attribution, and from the public-update coordinate to the value–realization repair difference. That residual claim is architectural and methodological, not the discovery that grammar is semiotic, paradigmatic, or interactionally consequential.

3 CROSS-LEVEL ARCHITECTURE

The neutral bearer of the proposal is a candidate **FORM–VALUE ASSEMBLY RELATION** in a conditioned community repertoire. Calling the bearer a “grammatical system” would assume the classification to be explained; calling it merely a “system” would include vowel inventories, orthographies, politeness routines, and practices of apologizing. A candidate relation instead specifies an expression, a semantic or relational value, the larger construction in which they combine, and the community and situations in which the dependency is claimed to hold.

Its **GRAMMATICAL-CHOICE PROFILE** records three blocks:

1. **SEMIOTIC AND CONSTRUCTIONAL ASSEMBLY:** conventional coupling between expression and semantic, relational, or structural value, recurring at a specifiable site in larger expressions.
2. **CHOICE ARCHITECTURE:** alternatives organized in a language-specific domain and frame, with their boundedness and conditioned requirements on selection, omission, or realization recorded.
3. **CONDITIONED LICENSING:** the relation’s position and generality in a multi-grain constructional chain, and the concentration of its use across the declared community, situations, medium, and period.

Public-update contribution is measured alongside this structural profile in §4; it isn’t smuggled into every grammatical classification. No block is a disguised judgment score. Positive production distributions, substitution and omission contrasts, semantic interpretation, productivity, and opportunity-normalized licensing evidence place the candidate before the fault labels, corrections, or repairs to be predicted are inspected. A descriptive grammar contributes only through evidence of those relations, not by lending the study its prior use of “grammatical”. The theoretical paper proposes no universal scalar; concrete studies have to preregister ordinal or pairwise comparisons, or a composite and its weighting rule.

The profile is deliberately graded. A strict paradigm has a recurring domain, a language-specific

frame, a bounded set of alternatives, obligatory value selection in the domain, and marked–unmarked organization (Nørgård-Sørensen & Heltoft, 2015, pp. 262–263). It anchors a strong region of the space. A productive constructional dependency may be less bounded; an item-specific complement restriction may sit deep in a grammatical licensing chain while resembling lexical collocation at its narrowest link. These needn’t be equal cases, and neither has to be excluded by a classical definition before its projections are tested. Hansen and Heltoft’s own grammar permits prototype and radial organization (Hansen & Heltoft, 2011, vol. 1, 39–41).

Three kinds of gradience need to remain distinct. The worldly dependency can have an intermediate profile; evidence for its placement can be uncertain; and a speaker or institution can issue a sharp or hesitant label. A categorical classroom correction doesn’t prove a strong grammatical profile, and uncertain evidence doesn’t prove a fuzzy system. Profiles and category edges can also move across communities, activities, media, and time. Those changes are part of the claim’s scope, not exceptions to be hidden after a miss.

OVMG supplies a second decomposition at the token level. Once a candidate analysis and its conditioning situation are fixed, COVERAGE asks whether an analysis exists; COMPATIBILITY whether its grammatical instructions can jointly hold; SATURATION whether required contrasts have values; and LICENSING whether the community supports the construction and realization. Population status, evidence available to a speaker or analyst, and the resulting subjective read-out remain separate (Reynolds, 2026a). This paper uses those distinctions to locate a possible fault without reproducing OVMG’s dynamics.

Question	Bearer	Possible failure	Example
Conditioning	Candidate plus situation and norm centre	wrong repertoire or context has been assumed	formal/informal contrast
Coverage	Proposed constructional analysis	no viable assembly of the supplied material	<i>*Can the have running?</i>
Compatibility	Values in a covered analysis	independently supplied instructions conflict	<i>*I’ve finished it yesterday</i>
Saturation	Obligatory contrast in a covered analysis	required value remains unsupplied	omitted obligatory marker
Licensing	Construction or realization in a repertoire	transparent candidate is conventionally excluded	<i>*depend of; *le hiver</i>
Value selection	Token of an identified paradigm	licensed competitor selects the wrong value here	same vs. different subject
Non-assembly target	Licensed sign or social act	content, spelling, stance, persona, situation, or conduct is at issue	register mismatch

Table 2: Cross-level diagnostic questions. Value and realization specify loci inside the broader compatibility and licensing questions. A response can target more than one row, and its cause is separate.

The primary projective claim, SELECTIVE FAULT ATTRIBUTION, now has a non-trivial form. For candidate dependencies in a declared community, situation, medium, and period, a stronger profile assigned without attribution evidence should predict more consistent grammar-directed classification of held-out interpretable deviations. Frequency, processing load, semantic reparability, discursive secondary status, schooling, and sanction are rival predictors. Before a concrete study, the minimum useful improvement and uncertainty rule has to be declared. If the profile adds no held-out reach, it’s demoted or split; the misses may not be excluded by redescribing the relation after the responses are seen.

The account predicts attribution; respondents can still classify incorrectly. An institutional grammar label can target a weakly profiled shibboleth, while an unprimed speaker can treat a strong but

changing dependency as lexical or stylistic. The proposal predicts a robust core, layered interfaces, and moving edges rather than exceptionless agreement.

This makes **le hiver* informative. Its definite, masculine, singular values remain recoverable. The failure is the unelided realization inside an ordinary French determiner phrase, not the selection of a different value. The analysis is deliberately neutral between deriving *l'* by vowel deletion and treating it as an allomorph: both locate the error in morphophonological realization rather than concord (Borsma, 2007). The example establishes neither a wrong value, the containing system's paradigm status, nor its public-update profile. It functions instead as an interface test. Spoken schwa retention, written non-elision, learner speech, and a deliberate pause can make different dependencies and norm centres salient, so the account permits mixed phonological, orthographic, learner, or grammatical-form attribution. In OVMG terms, the intended definite assembly is covered, compatible, and saturated; the disputed relation is realization licensing in the specified environment.

Repeated opportunities help explain why such a transparent failure can be sharp. Once the domain and alternatives are independently specified, a small competitor set allows evidence to concentrate quickly on the licensed option. OVMG develops that licensing and preemption account (Reynolds, 2026a). Information theory can quantify the resulting uncertainty reduction, but it can't discover the grammatical alternatives or decide which fault domain a community recognizes. The linguistic codebook is an input to that calculation, not its output (Cover & Thomas, 2006; Shannon, 1948).

For the narrower operator-profile comparison below, study eligibility is categorical even though grammaticality isn't. A candidate paradigm has to have bounded alternatives, a recurring domain, a shared frame, and obligatory value selection; markedness is recorded, with a strict five-criterion sensitivity analysis. This gate prevents an open set from entering a value-realization experiment merely because some members matter to interaction. It's a design rule for that comparison, not a definition of grammar.

4 PUBLIC-UPDATE PROFILES

Fault location doesn't yet predict what a hearer will do with the trouble. An identified paradigm receives a graded profile for the extent to which its values conventionally configure four aspects of public update: move type, commitment holder or source, discourse-participant or referent continuity, and response relevance (Farkas & Bruce, 2010; Murray, 2014; Stalnaker, 2002). The components form a vector, not four additional membership conditions. Clause type, evidential anchoring, and switch-reference are strong candidates; neither thematic-role assignment nor formal obligatoriness is sufficient on its own.

The profile belongs to the paradigm across its ordinary occasions of use, not to the information carried by every token. An agreement marker can be redundant in one clause and decisive in another. Licensed update type also differs from truth or success: a false assertion is still an assertion, while a wrong same-subject value can redirect reference tracking even when the speaker's intention is recoverable.

Within identified paradigms, a WRONG-VALUE error changes the grammatical choice. A VALUE-PRESERVING-REALIZATION error retains that choice but uses an excluded exponent or surface form. The OPERATOR-PROFILE HYPOTHESIS states that, for paradigms in a specified community and activity range that independently support both error types, a stronger frozen profile predicts a larger held-

out difference in update-directed repair between them. The within-paradigm contrast checks the manipulation; the cross-paradigm interaction is the explanatory claim.

The bridge is a conditional claim about sufficient repair. When trouble is detected and participants pursue mutual understanding, a response can target the lowest locus whose correction settles the public record. A wrong value in a high-profile paradigm can leave move type, commitment, reference continuity, or response relevance unsettled; correcting surface form alone may be insufficient. When the intended value is independently recoverable and only its realization is excluded, supplying the licensed form can settle the trouble without renegotiating the update. This doesn't make overt repair inevitable. Accommodation, high recoverability, non-response, mishearing, and person-directed sanction are counterpressures and remain in the outcome space.

The information-theoretic intuition concerns a code's organization, not merely token surprisal. Recurrent constrained choices create redundancy: a hearer can recover the intended value precisely because the licensed competitors make the deviation easy to detect. Recoverability doesn't show that the violated relation carries no grammatical information. Public-update profiling asks a different counterfactual question: how much would choosing another licensed value change the move, commitment, continuity, or relevant response space? Entropy or divergence can summarize that change only after linguistic analysis supplies the alternatives (Cover & Thomas, 2006; Shannon, 1948).

I retain OPERATOR STRATUM only as shorthand for the higher-profile region of this ordering. It introduces no threshold or second membership category. Repair and comprehension are outcomes, never profile criteria. A high-profile paradigm may be accommodated, ignored, sanctioned, or corrected only in form; those responses count against the hypothesis rather than licensing a post-hoc redescription.

Opportunity remains distinct. It affects how concentrated the evidence for a licensed realization becomes, not whether a contrast is a paradigm or how strongly its values configure public update. Likewise, historical recruitment is a separate question. Grammaticalization research documents the recruitment of material into grammatical and discourse functions, often through paradigmatic reorganization (Degand & Evers-Vermeul, 2015; Hopper & Traugott, 2003; Jakobsen & Heltoft, 2012; Lehmann, 2015; Waltereit, 2011). It doesn't establish that public-update work preferentially creates paradigms, and diachronic conjecture can't rescue a failed synchronic prediction.

Expressive substance is also independent. Morphology, word order, particles, tone, intonation, and nonmanual marking can all realize values in identified paradigms. Phonemic systems can be tightly organized while serving primarily to distinguish expressions; open interjectional resources can strongly configure uptake without forming a bounded paradigm (Ameka, 1992). Paradigm structure, public-update profile, and expressive substance answer different questions.

5 WORKED COMPARISONS AND BOUNDARY ANCHORS

The architecture needs examples that keep value and realization apart. It also needs boundary anchors that expose rather than stipulate the proposed category edge. Table 3 records candidate analyses and attributions; none is an observed result.

The French example remains the motivating realization case, but it isn't a concord case and supplies no wrong-value counterpart. **Goed* is parallel at a coarser, lexeme-specific grain: the past value survives while the established exponent *went* displaces the productive default. **Depend of* is layered. Complementation selects a function; that function constrains a phrasal category; the PP option in-

Case	Failed dependency	Profile expectation	Candidate attribution
Wrong paradigm value	value selection in a recurring domain	strong where strict paradigm criteria hold	grammar/value; possibly update
<i>*le hiver</i>	conditioned article realization	construction-embedded but phonology- and medium-sensitive	grammatical form, phonology, or orthography
<i>*goed</i>	past realization for one lexeme	inflectional choice plus item-specific licensing	grammatical form or word form
<i>*depend of</i> + OBJ	item-restricted link in a complement chain	grammatical at higher links, collocational at narrowest link	construction or wording
Register or accent mismatch	situational fit of a licensed indexical value	form–value coupling without necessary assembly failure	style, persona, or social norm
Misspelling	graphic realization of a linguistic expression	representation relation normally preserves linguistic assembly	orthography

Table 3: Boundary anchors for selective attribution. Profile expectations have to be fixed independently; the final column is a prediction, not a classification criterion.

roduces an item-restricted preposition choice. The higher links have strong schematic and assembly profiles, whereas the final *depend–on* restriction approaches lexical collocation. Mixed construction-versus-wording attribution would support the layered analysis rather than count as noise. Sharp correction of any of the three would by itself establish neither the source profile nor a high operator profile.

5.1 AMELE FINITE TENSE

Amele supplies the strongest source-grounded template presently available. Its finite verb paradigm distinguishes present, today past, and yesterday past; the grammar also states temporal co-occurrence restrictions and gives the morphophonological derivations of the forms (Roberts, 1987, pp. 226–232, 380–385). Holding the verb ‘come’ and first-person singular subject constant yields the comparison in Table 4.

Condition	Amele form	Analysis
Licensed target	<i>Ija bu-g-a</i>	‘I came today/have come’
Wrong value	<i>Ija bu-g-an</i>	licensed yesterday-past form in an unambiguously earlier-today context
Preserved value, wrong realization	<i>*Ija ho-ig-a</i>	today-past and 1sg material retained, but obligatory vowel coalescence fails

Table 4: A proposed Amele finite-tense comparison. The final form is derived from the published morphophonology and requires speaker validation.

The value error substitutes a licensed competitor from the same tense paradigm. The realization error retains the today-past suffix *-a* and first-person singular material but fails the derivation */ho+ig+a/* → *[buga]*. Roberts independently stars a comparable nonapplication or misordering outcome elsewhere in the finite paradigm, which supports the analysis without supplying a judgment for this exact item (Roberts, 1987, pp. 380–385). The result is a theoretically clean template, not a ready-made experimental result. A future use has to validate the constructed form, equate perceptual distance, and avoid the flexible nighttime boundary between today and yesterday past.

Nothing in the grammatical label assigns the tense paradigm a high profile. Study B Stage 1b has to determine how strongly its values alter temporal anchoring, commitment, or response relevance. The worked case establishes that value and realization can be manipulated separately.

5.2 AMELE SWITCH-REFERENCE

The sequential switch-reference paradigm provides a second template. Amele distinguishes same-subject (SS) and different-subject (DS) linkage on a medial verb, with separate person–number sets and vowel harmony in the DS marker (Roberts, 1987, pp. 239–240, 298–300, 371). For a second-person subject followed by a third-person subject, the comparison is:

Condition	Amele form	Analysis
Licensed target	<i>Hina ho-co-m sab je-i-a</i>	‘You came and he ate the food’ (DS)
Wrong value	* <i>Hina b-u-me-g sab je-i-a</i>	licensed 2sg SS form with a different following subject
Preserved value, wrong realization	* <i>Hina ho-ce-m sab je-i-a</i>	DS and 2sg material retained, but the DS vowel is disharmonic after <i>ho-</i>

Table 5: A proposed Amele switch-reference comparison. Both starred sentences require validation in the intended clause-chain context.

Here the wrong-value token changes the tracking instruction, while the disharmonic token preserves DS. The grammar directly supports the licensed SS and DS forms and the harmony relation, but it doesn’t print the exact **ho-ce-m* stimulus. SS/DS choice is also sensitive to agentivity, clause level, time, place, world, and pragmatic deixis. Those factors have to be frozen rather than treated as noise. Because SS and DS use different person–number material, the two error conditions also differ in more than one segment; perceptual salience belongs in the design.

Switch-reference is a plausible high-continuity profile, but that expectation isn’t a score. A separate profiling partition has to establish whether changing SS to DS alters reference continuity and downstream response options. The worked comparison shows what an eligible case would look like and where its remaining evidential risks lie.

5.3 NEIGHBORING TARGETS AND MOVING EDGES

Gender and noun-class concord stress-test the paradigm-level analysis. A token such as **le table* may leave the intended referent obvious while violating obligatory French concord. Local redundancy doesn’t show that the containing paradigm lacks a reference-tracking role, but neither does categorical correction prove that it has one (Corbett, 1991; Mahowald et al., 2023). Independent profiling has to compare contexts in which lexical semantics already fixes the referent with contexts in which concord changes participant tracking.

Accent, register, and Japanese polite/plain style supply low-profile or non-paradigm comparisons only after their conditioned repertoires are specified (Agha, 2007; Cook, 2008; Eckert, 2012; Ide, 2005). Their deviations can be highly accountable while targeting stance, persona, or institutional norms. The form can express exactly the social value conventionally associated with it and still be wrong for the occasion. In that case the pairing has succeeded; situational fit is the target. But an honorific or T/V contrast that acquires a recurring domain, bounded alternatives, and conditioned

selection can move toward the grammatical core. The theory has to allow that result rather than assigning indexical meaning outside grammar by stipulation.

Phonology and orthography sharpen the same point. A phonemic contrast ordinarily serves sign discrimination rather than pairing each segment with a meaning. A spelling system ordinarily maps graphic forms to linguistic expressions. Their departures can leave the relevant linguistic form–value assembly intact. Morphophonology and grammatical tone cross the boundary when a phonological contrast realizes a constructional or paradigm value. **le hiver* is informative because respondents may locate the same surface departure at that interface differently across speech, writing, learner correction, and deliberate pauses.

The lexicon contains semiotic pairings. Words are form–meaning pairings, but choosing an ill-fitting licensed word normally preserves its pairing and the larger assembly. Selectional restrictions, valence frames, and item-specific complement patterns create intermediate cases when lexical material constrains how a construction is assembled. **Depend of* is useful only if the licensing chain is specified in advance; calling it simply lexical or grammatical would throw away the prediction.

These interfaces motivate the second broad projection, MOVING-EDGE ATTRIBUTION. Independently measured changes in recurrence, constructional embedding, boundedness, conditioned selection, or population concentration should predict movement and increased variation among grammatical, lexical, and stylistic attributions. The source profile may change historically or differ across activities; those comparisons require separately declared populations and periods. Schooling is a rival cause: an institution can preserve a grammar label after spontaneous production and licensing have shifted. Unprimed attribution and explicit schoolroom classification have to be measured separately.

Interjections and slurs make the converse point: a resource can reshape uptake or social action without entering a bounded grammatical paradigm (Ameka, 1992). These cases prevent public consequence from becoming a shortcut to either grammatical-choice or public-update profile.

6 INCREMENTAL PREDICTOR COMPARISON

The nearest predictors have to be compared within their native scope rather than forced into a winner-take-all theory of language. Table 6 states what each can directly predict in the proposed study.

Predictor	Applicability gate	Direct prediction	Probative result
Abrusán: type level, locality, shiftability	semantic or pragmatic analysis of the anomaly	whether local meaning repair preserves a coherent predication	explains semantic targets and absorbs apparent profile effects
Boye–Harder: discursive secondary status	expression stands in the relevant syntagmatic relation	grammatical status and associated focusability/addressability pattern	secondary status predicts attribution beyond the choice profile or repair beyond paradigm structure
Grammatical-choice profile	independently profiled form–value assembly relation	consistency and domain of grammar-directed attribution	incremental held-out allocation beyond frequency, processing, schooling, and sanction
Public-update profile	independently identified paradigm with both error types	value/realization difference in update-directed repair grows with profile	incremental interaction after status rivals and licensing variables are represented

Table 6: Scope-fair predictor comparison. An N/A case is outside a predictor’s native explanandum, not evidence against it.

Abrusán’s account may fully explain items whose apparent grammaticality is a semantic composition failure. Boye and Harder may better identify grammatical status generally. The grammatical-

choice profile earns its broader role only if its independently measured architecture predicts held-out target allocation. The operator profile earns its narrower role only if it then adds reach for the consequences of value errors. A broad interpretive-consequence measure also has to be allowed to subsume it: if any consequential contrast predicts repair equally well, the specifically public-update attribution fails.

7 HELD-OUT TESTS AND DEFEAT CONDITIONS

The theoretical answer generates three projections. **SELECTIVE FAULT ATTRIBUTION** is primary: the independently assigned grammatical-choice profile should predict whether held-out trouble is directed at grammar. **MOVING-EDGE ATTRIBUTION** predicts greater variation and migration among grammar, lexicon, and style where the source profile is intermediate or changing. The **OPERATOR-PROFILE HYPOTHESIS** is downstream: among eligible paradigms, public-update profile should predict the repair difference between wrong values and value-preserving realization errors. The first two address the question in the title; the third tests one proposed consequence within grammar.

Freezing the source profiles isn't enough. The outcome codebook also has to be fixed before responses are inspected. Prospective elicitation and corpora with disjoint profiling and outcome partitions can implement the same inferential order.

STUDY A, STAGE 1: CHOICE PROFILING. Candidate dependencies are sampled without first sorting them into grammatical and non-grammatical bins. For each declared community, situation, medium, and period, production and descriptive evidence specify the expression–value relation, constructional site, contrastive frame, alternatives, selection and omission restrictions, licensing chain, productivity, and population distribution. Negative labels, corrections, repair, and the held-out items are withheld. Profile components remain visible; a scalar or ordinal summary, weighting rule, missing-data rule, and uncertainty treatment are fixed for the particular study rather than declared universal.

Published descriptions count only through their underlying positive evidence: attested production, substitution and omission contrasts, conventional interpretation, productivity, and distribution across independently specified opportunities. A grammarian's asterisk or category label is attribution evidence and can't be recycled as source-profile evidence.

The comparison set should include strong paradigms and constructions, value-preserving realization dependencies such as past-tense exponence, item-restricted constructional chains, open lexical choices, phonological and orthographic relations, indexical or stylistic pairings, and social-act cases. The deviations have to remain interpretable. Frequency, perceptual distance, processing load, task framing, schooling, and sanction are restricted, matched, or represented as rival predictors. Boye–Harder diagnostics and Abrusán-inspired semantic repairability are measured only in the domains where their theories apply.

STUDY A, STAGE 2: FROZEN ATTRIBUTION. New items, speakers, or a disjoint corpus partition are first coded for the apparent target: assembly relation, selected content, expression shape, spelling, situational or indexical fit, social act, mixed target, or unresolved trouble. A construction-directed response isn't automatically grammar-directed, because lexical constructions are part of the boundary to be explained. Open descriptions or repairs should precede forced labels so that a classroom vocabulary isn't built into the response. Explicit use of “grammar” is a separate, norm-sensitive outcome. Compound responses remain compound, and reliability and uncertainty are reported.

The primary test asks whether the frozen choice profile improves held-out spontaneous assembly-directed attribution, and separately explicit grammar labels, over the declared rivals by at least the prospectively chosen useful margin. The moving-edge test asks whether independently intermediate or changing profiles predict greater attributional variation and the declared direction of movement. A miss defeats or splits the corresponding claim. In particular, sharp school-taught labels with weak source profiles support institutional transmission as a cause of the read-out, not a post-hoc upgrade of the relation.

STUDY B, STAGE 1A: STRICT-PARADIGM IDENTIFICATION. For the narrower operator comparison, descriptive and corpus evidence first specifies the conditioned repertoire, recurring domain, alternatives, and semantic frame. It then tests whether the set is closed and whether a value has to be selected whenever the domain applies. Sharp judgments, correction, and the later repair task are withheld. Tense–aspect systems, agreement paradigms, switch-reference markers, interrogative particles, and complementizer inventories are candidates, not presumed cases. This triangulation implements Poulsen’s caution: widespread production is strong evidence for a construction, but nonoccurrence, rare production, processing cost, and acceptability each underdetermine stable conventional knowledge when considered alone (Poulsen, 2012, pp. 15–20).

Closure requires a bounded value inventory that exhausts the choices found in the specified domain across additional corpus samples and, where needed, consultant elicitation. Productive new exponents can realize existing values; a productive route to new values, or an open residual “other” response, defeats closure. The conditioned repertoire and stopping rule are fixed before the outcome task.

Obligatory selection requires every independently accepted token in the domain to receive one value from that inventory. A zero realization counts only where its distribution contrasts with overt members in the same frame and independently changes the frame interpretation. Mere lack of an overt form doesn’t establish a zero value; it may instead show that the proposed domain isn’t active.

Dropping Nørgård-Sørensen and Heltoft’s markedness criterion enlarges the possible comparison set. Each study reports the primary four-criterion analysis and a sensitivity analysis restricted to paradigms that also show their marked–unmarked asymmetry. A result that disappears in the strict subset supports only the relaxed comparison and can’t be attributed to their full architecture.

STUDY B, STAGE 1B: OPERATOR PROFILING. For each identified paradigm, preregister the update variables its values might affect: move type, commitment holder or source, discourse-participant or referent continuity, and response relevance. A separate sample or corpus partition supplies minimal value contrasts while holding at-issue content as constant as the language permits. Classification, interpretation, or independently coded distributional measures estimate how much changing the value changes each component.

Stage 1b yields a four-component vector. A concrete study may preregister an ordinal comparison or a scalar summary, but the theory supplies no universal weights. Zero effects remain visible rather than being dropped as “inapplicable”; indicator coding, scaling, missing-data rules, contexts, and uncertainty aggregation are frozen before repair outcomes are inspected.

Profiling evidence stops at the target utterance. It can include blinded coding of its conventional move type, commitment source, reference continuity, and licensed response potential, or comprehension probes that classify those properties. It can’t include negative judgments, trouble reports, correction wording, repair initiation, or the observed next turn. If Stage 2 uses interactional out-

comes, disjoint next-turn samples aren't independent profiling evidence. This exclusion is stricter than holding out items from the same task.

This step has an information-theoretic interpretation only after the linguistic codebook has been specified. Entropy reduction or divergence among response options judged compatible with an utterance can quantify how strongly a value constrains possible updates (Cover & Thomas, 2006; Shannon, 1948); it can't determine whether the alternatives form a grammatical paradigm or whether a departure is normatively classified as an error. Information theory measures a consequence of the supplied value contrast. It doesn't supply system membership, fault locus, or social accountability, and token surprisal remains a separate covariate.

Study B Stage 2 uses a different task format and new items, such as open next-turn responses, production repair, or a held-out interactional corpus partition. Two theoretical rivals are measured in Study B Stage 1. The first is a semantic-repairability index motivated by Abrusán and colleagues: blinded coders assess whether at-issue content, predicate–argument structure, and event identity can be recovered through a local meaning shift, together with the locality and independently diagnosed type level of the conflict, without the four update labels or a repair prompt (Abrusán, 2019; Abrusán et al., 2021). The second is Boye and Harder's discursive-secondary-status diagnostics. The component scores of semantic repairability remain visible rather than being hidden in a single post-hoc scale. The analysis reports both rivals' correlations with the operator profile before fitting the confirmatory model. If the design can't distinguish these predictors at the achieved support, the study is non-identifying: it confirms neither the operator attribution nor its failure. Broad scope and interpersonal consequence are insufficient on their own.

Abrusán's measure is N/A, not zero, where no independent semantic type or composition conflict exists. Pure realization and ordinary licensing failures thereby fall outside that theory's scope. Boye–Harder diagnostics directly address grammatical status; their use as a predictor of next-turn repair is an explicit extension rather than a test of their account as a whole.

Sharing conceptual dimensions doesn't make the outcome definitional. Stage 1b classifies what a value conventionally configures; Stage 2 asks whether a respondent directs trouble there. A high-profile wrong value can be accommodated, ignored, sanctioned, or met with form-only correction. Such responses remain in the denominator and count against the predicted repair-locus difference.

DESIGN COVARIATES. Opportunity is the number of occasions on which a paradigm value and its competitors could plausibly have been selected. Exponent frequency, surprisal, constructional frame, phonetic salience, processing load, schooling or norm exposure, and social sanction are measured separately. Wherever possible, restriction and matching handle these item- or token-level variables before estimation. The confirmatory model isn't a regression on the whole list: it contains the frozen profile, error locus, their interaction, the two pre-specified theoretical rivals at their appropriate levels, and only adjustments retained by a prospective design simulation. These are design commitments, not controls the theoretical paper claims already to have achieved. Opportunity predicts the concentration of licensing evidence, not paradigm status or operator profile (Reynolds, 2026a).

Correction is socially organized, so response cause can't be inferred from response wording. Activity, medium, register, participant role, learner status, schooling, and the norm centre made relevant in the interaction are specified before sampling (Cameron, 2012). A form-focused correction can be caused by institutional authority; an update-directed repair can arise from ordinary mishearing. The outcome code locates the apparent target, while the design variables address causes.

Mixing incompatible norm centres changes the population target rather than merely adding noise.

STUDY B, STAGE 2: FROZEN OUTCOMES. Before coding held-out responses, define **UPDATE**, **CONFUSION**, **UPDATE-DIRECTED REPAIR**, **FORM CORRECTION**, **CONSTRUCTIONAL CORRECTION**, **SOCIAL SANCTION**, and **UNRESOLVED TROUBLE**. Update-directed repair targets move type, commitment, discourse-participant or referent continuity, or response relevance; form correction supplies a licensed realization and preserves the intended update. Double-code ambiguous responses and report reliability rather than forcing every case into one bin. The confirmatory comparison includes only paradigms for which independent evidence supports both a genuine value mismatch and a plausible value-preserving realization mismatch; the design can't manufacture the latter merely to retain a paradigm. Eligibility and its relation to expressive substance are reported before profiling. The confirmatory claim concerns this eligible population, not paradigms for which a value-preserving control is unavailable. Those paradigms require a separately labelled extension with a different form or constructional control.

One cross-paradigm interaction supplies the sole confirmatory test for Study B: does the wrong-value versus value-preserving-realization difference in update-directed repair increase with the frozen operator profile after the pre-specified restrictions, matches, and limited adjustments? The within-paradigm difference is a manipulation check, repair locus is the primary outcome, and held-out comprehension is secondary. Repeated responses don't substitute for independent paradigms when estimating this interaction. Before calling a study confirmatory, design simulation has to show that the planned paradigm sample can distinguish the minimum effect from zero at the declared uncertainty threshold. An underpowered or non-identifying corpus analysis is a pilot and licenses neither confirmation nor failure. In an adequately powered identifying study, an absent or smaller interaction defeats the operator-profile hypothesis even if paradigm descriptions and operator profiles remain useful.

PROJECTIVE DECLARATIONS AND REVISION RULES. Study A projects from a frozen choice profile to grammar-directed attribution for held-out candidate dependencies in the declared community, situation, medium, and period. Its moving-edge component projects from independently intermediate or changing profiles to attributional variation or migration across declared groups or times. Study B projects from the frozen profile of an eligible paradigm to its held-out wrong-value-realization difference in update-directed repair. Each study declares a minimum useful effect and uncertainty threshold. The prospective comparisons, rival measures, and separation of tasks supply the warrant; they aren't part of the world-side profiles. Failure retires or splits the corresponding attribution for that scope. A preregistered narrower analysis may be reported as a different claim, but it doesn't rescue the broader one (Goodman, 1955; Reynolds, 2026b).

No newly recruited participant sample is logically required for an initial pilot. Existing correction, interactional, learner, metalinguistic, and usage data can be divided into disjoint profiling and outcome partitions, supplemented by descriptive grammars and independent distributional evidence. Such corpora are selected records of when people correct, but they aren't clean samples of community classification. Naturally occurring wrong-value and realization errors may also be too sparse or unevenly distributed for identification. A corpus study can validate search, profile placement, eligibility, and coding procedures without being promoted into a test the data can't support.

8 PREDICTIONS AND RESEARCH STRATEGIES

The paper makes three prospective claims, all conditional on the pre-outcome identification and coding stages in §7. The first two answer the selective-classification question; the third isolates the operator-specific consequence.

(1) **SELECTIVE FAULT ATTRIBUTION.** Independently stronger grammatical-choice profiles should produce more consistent grammar-directed attribution for held-out interpretable deviations. The comparison isn't "grammar versus random bad sentences". It has to include licensed but poor lexical choices, phonological and orthographic deviations, situationally misplaced indexical values, social-act violations, constructional failures, wrong paradigm values, and value-preserving realization errors. The prediction fails if frequency, processing, schooling, sanction, semantic reparability, or discursive secondary status supplies the useful allocation and the choice profile doesn't.

(2) **MOVING-EDGE ATTRIBUTION.** Independently intermediate and changing profiles should produce greater variability and directed migration among grammar, lexicon, and style attributions. An item-specific restriction embedded in a constructional chain should be less consistently grammar-directed than a schematic obligatory dependency but more so than an open collocation, other conditions matched. Across a declared period, a weakening dependency should lose spontaneous grammar-directed attribution as recurrence, embedding, or licensing concentration declines. Persistent classroom labels may lag; that lag supports institutional transmission as a response cause, not continued strength of the source profile.

(3) **THE OPERATOR-PROFILE-BY-ERROR-LOCUS INTERACTION.** Conversation favours self-repair over other-correction: other-correction is dispreferred, while other-initiation of repair is common and usually gives the original speaker an opportunity to repair (Dingemanse et al., 2015; Schegloff et al., 1977). Within each eligible identified paradigm, wrong-value items should disproportionately produce clarification of force, commitment, role, or reference; value-preserving realization errors should disproportionately produce form correction with the intended update retained. That within-paradigm difference checks the manipulation. The confirmatory coefficient is its interaction with the independently assigned operator profile across eligible paradigms.

A higher correction rate for high-profile paradigms is too weak a prediction. **Depend of* + OBJ can elicit "you mean X" through constructional licensing, and a socially marked form can elicit person-targeted sanction. The confirmatory outcome is the locus of the response, not correction rate alone. Cross-linguistic repair research supplies broader coding precedents but not validation of the proposed interaction; Fox and colleagues specifically code same-turn syntactic self-repair rather than the held-out next-turn categories used here (Dingemanse et al., 2014, 2015; Fox et al., 1996). Adult interaction with little formal-school correction can reduce one prescriptive rival, but dialect, learner status, institutional role, and task format remain measured accountability conditions.

Two stress tests concern Claim 3. **LOCAL REDUNDANCY.** In gender, agreement, and reference-tracking systems, a manipulation can leave one token's interpretation unchanged while the paradigm remains informative across its opportunities. After Study B Stage 1b has assigned the profile, held-out contexts should show token-level null effects where lexical semantics already determines the referent and positive effects where reference is underdetermined. The local null is predicted; reassigning the profile after seeing it isn't permitted. A low-profile paradigm that produces the same value-versus-realization repair difference as a high-profile paradigm counts against the hypothesis.

EXPRESSIVE SUBSTANCE. Where tone, intonation, or nonmanual marking realizes values in an

identified paradigm and both mismatch types are independently supported, the same profile-by-error-locus interaction should appear after opportunity, frequency, and perceptual salience are matched (Hyman, 2011; Ladd, 2008). Tsiwah et al. (2021) report a P600-like response to one temporal-agreement violation in Akan, where time reference is expressed through grammatical tone; this prediction concerns the broader matched repair profile, not a unique ERP component. Compare tonal tense mismatches, segmental tense or agreement mismatches, and sociophonetic tone shifts. Wrong values may prompt reanalysis of material in scope; value-preserving realization errors should concentrate correction on the form. This interaction is more specific than the familiar contrast between morphosyntactic and conceptual anomaly (Friederici, 2011; Kutas & Hillyard, 1980; Osterhout & Holcomb, 1992).

The failure conditions belong to the contribution statement. The general answer fails if the frozen choice profile adds no useful held-out prediction of fault attribution. The moving-edge claim fails if independently ordered or changing profiles don't predict attributional variation or direction. In an adequately powered identifying study, the operator-profile hypothesis adds no explanatory value if the frozen profile doesn't predict the held-out value-versus-realization repair difference after the pre-specified design restrictions, semantic repairability, and discursive secondary status. Source descriptions and component profiles may remain useful; the failed projection doesn't. Inseparable rivals or insufficient independent cases make a study inconclusive, not supportive by default.

The same inferential order applies whether a test uses new elicitation or disjoint partitions of existing corpora: profile candidate dependencies; where relevant, identify strict paradigms and public-update effects; freeze rivals and outcome codes; and only then inspect the held-out attributions or repairs.

9 CONCLUSION

Why, then, does one interpretable deviation count as ungrammatical while another doesn't? The proposed answer is that speakers imperfectly track the relation that failed. Grammar consists centrally of conventional form–meaning pairings, but neither conventionality, pairing, nor systemhood is sufficient. The grammatical core consists of relations used recurrently to assemble expressions: constructions, relational values, obligatory choices, and their licensed realizations. Strict paradigms anchor that core; construction-sized and item-restricted dependencies produce layered cases. Selecting a poor but licensed word, style, accent, or social act can instead preserve the relevant assembly and make content, situational fit, persona, or conduct the fault target.

That's a graded, scoped answer rather than an exceptionless definition. A candidate relation receives a profile from form–value coupling, recurrence, contrastive choice architecture, and conditioned community licensing without using the labels to be predicted. A stronger profile is then expected to support more consistent grammar-directed attribution in held-out cases. The worldly profile, our uncertainty about it, and the sharpness of a respondent's label remain distinct. Edges can also move with community, activity, medium, and time.

The motivating French example makes the point precisely. In ordinary connected Reference French, **le biver* preserves referent, definiteness, number, and gender while using an unelided realization before an H MUET noun. The dependency is morphophonological, but it's embedded in article realization. That makes grammatical-form attribution plausible without turning the item into a concord or wrong-value case. It also makes the example a genuine interface: speech, writing, pausing,

learner correction, and norm centre can shift attribution toward phonology, orthography, or grammatical realization. Those possibilities test the profile account rather than disappearing by definition.

OVMG contributes the token-level and epistemic decomposition. Coverage, compatibility, saturation, and licensing locate distinct possible failures; population status, evidence, and subjective read-out aren't one variable. Opportunity and strong competitors can explain why a transparent value-preserving realization becomes sharply excluded. They don't decide the fault label from frequency alone, and institutional teaching or stigma can make the label mis-track the source profile.

Public-update contribution adds a narrower claim. Among independently identified paradigms, values differ in how strongly they configure move type, commitment, reference continuity, and response relevance. Across paradigms that genuinely support both error types, a stronger frozen public-update profile is predicted to increase the difference in update-directed repair between wrong values and value-preserving realization errors. That projection explains neither **le hiver* nor grammar as a whole.

The proposal is cumulative. Abrusán and colleagues explain one major boundary through type level, locality, and semantic shiftability. Coseriu supplies a longstanding architecture of system, norm, speech, and evaluative domains. Heltoft shows how paradigmatic grammar organizes illocutionary and interlocutionary relations, while Nørgård-Sørensen and Heltoft provide the domain-frame scaffold adopted here. Boye and Harder's discursive secondary status remains a principled alternative predictor. The residual contribution is not a new ingredient but a cross-level decomposition and three prospective comparisons that can distinguish their reach.

The proposal can lose in three ways. If the frozen grammatical-choice profile doesn't improve held-out fault attribution beyond semantic repairability, discursive secondary status, frequency, processing, schooling, and sanction, the general answer fails or has to be split. If independently intermediate or changing profiles don't predict variable or moving attribution, the boundary claim fails. If the public-update profile does not predict the held-out value-realization repair difference in an identifying study, the operator-specific attribution fails. Descriptive analyses may survive each result; they may not be used to rename a failed projection as success.

Clausal architecture remains important because it can host paradigms for clause type, commitment, scope, and reference tracking. Tone, gesture, particles, word order, and inflection can realize those values. None of this makes every constraint on a clause high-profile, and the stronger historical suggestion that public-update work preferentially recruits paradigms remains unconfirmed.

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